

Telehealth Consultation Policy

Synthetic healthcare policy document for RAG testing

Document Notice

This file is synthetic and created only for healthcare AI assistant RAG testing. It does not contain real patient data, PHI, confidential client data, or actual medical advice.

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy explains when patients may use telehealth consultations for non-emergency healthcare support. Telehealth may be used for follow-up visits, minor health concerns, medication review, chronic condition check-ins, health education, and general guidance. It should not replace emergency care or urgent in-person assessment when immediate medical attention is needed.

2. Eligibility for Telehealth

Patients may use telehealth when their condition can be reasonably evaluated through audio, video, or secure messaging. New severe symptoms, major injuries, uncontrolled bleeding, severe chest pain, difficulty breathing, sudden weakness, or loss of consciousness are not appropriate for telehealth and require emergency care.

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3. Medication Review and Refills

Patients may request medication refills through telehealth if the medication is already prescribed, the patient is stable, and the medication does not require an in-person physical examination or restricted monitoring. The clinician may deny or delay refills if symptoms have changed, safety concerns exist, or updated tests are required.

4. Documentation Requirements

Clinicians must document the reason for the visit, patient identity verification, consent for telehealth, clinical notes, recommendations, prescriptions or refill decisions, and any advice for in-person follow-up. Documentation should be stored in the approved medical record system.

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5. Limitations

Telehealth cannot be used for direct emergency diagnosis, complex physical examination, procedures, imaging, or cases where the clinician determines that virtual care is unsafe. Patients must be advised to visit emergency services when red-flag symptoms are reported.

6. Patient Responsibilities

Patients should join from a private location, use accurate contact information, keep medication lists ready, describe symptoms clearly, and follow instructions provided by the clinician. Patients should not record the consultation without permission.

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7. Privacy and Security

Telehealth sessions must use approved secure platforms. Staff should not conduct visits from public locations. Patient information shared during telehealth must remain confidential and protected according to privacy policy.

8. Escalation

If the clinician identifies a possible emergency, the patient should be told to call emergency services or visit the nearest emergency department. The reason for escalation must be documented.

Quick Reference Table

Question	Policy Answer
Can a patient request refills through telehealth?	Yes, if the medication is already prescribed, the patient is stable, and no in-person exam or restricted monitoring is required.
Can telehealth handle chest pain?	No. Severe chest pain is an emergency/red-flag symptom and should be escalated to emergency care.
Does telehealth need consent?	Yes. Consent for telehealth should be documented.

Recommended RAG Test Prompts

- Can a patient request refills through telehealth?
- Can telehealth handle chest pain?
- Does telehealth need consent?
- What information is not available in this document?
- Summarize the main rules from this document.

Version: 1.0 | Data Type: Synthetic | Intended Use: Hackathon prototype and RAG demonstration.